

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

Can IonQ capture meaningful share of a \$50B global quantum TAM by 2036 with its trapped-ion stack — or is the \$26B market cap pricing certainty Quantinuum, Google, and neutral-atom don't support?

IonQ trades at ~\$26B against \$64.7M Q1 2026 revenue and FY26 guide \$260-270M — P/S >95×. \$2.39B cash + \$470M RPO + the \$1.8B SkyWater chip-fab acquisition is the optionality. Trapped-ion gives ~99.9%+ 2Q fidelity; AQ#64 on Tempo hit three months early. But the competitive set is brutal: Quantinuum IPOs at \$12.7B with better logical-qubit performance, Google's Willow demonstrated verifiable advantage on chemistry, and neutral-atom scaled past 1,200 qubits. Honest math: cash-feasible raise schedules force heavy dilution before commercial inflection. Five scenarios, weighted; show your work.

PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED EXPECTED VALUE

\$9.18 expected fair value today
-86.9% vs spot \$70.14

FORWARD COMPOUNDED VALUE

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
\$13.15	\$18.86	\$27.07	\$38.87
0.19× spot	0.27× spot	0.39× spot	0.55× spot

WEIGHTING RATIONALE

Ultra Bear 10% Trapped-ion scaling wall + Quantinuum dominance + commercial quantum advantage delayed past 2030; equity wipes via dilution.

Bear 30% Quantinuum's IPO + better logical qubits push IonQ to #2 within trapped-ion; smaller TAM than consensus.

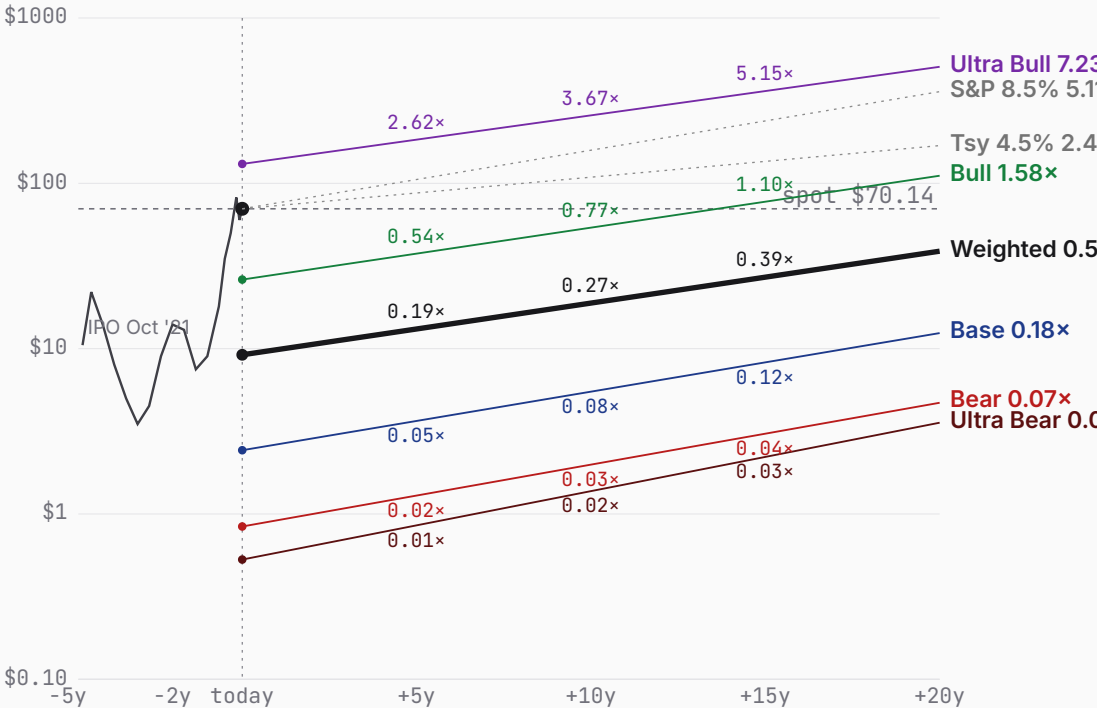
Base 42% Sequential execution on roadmap; co-leader duopoly with Quantinuum at ~8% TAM share and 17% mature margin.

Bull 15% Vertical SkyWater integration pays off; IonQ wins trapped-ion premium and platform race.

Ultra Bull 3% Tail of tails: Nvidia-of-quantum + TAM upside + competitor stumbles + multiple expansion.

Bull (15%) + Ultra Bull (3%) together contribute \$7.86 — 86% of the \$9.18 expected value despite 18% combined probability. Today's spot (\$70.14) sits 664% above the weighted expected; forward-weighted value crosses spot between +5y and +10y.

PRICE + PROJECTIONS · HISTORICAL THROUGH PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED



ULTRA BEAR	\$0.53	BEAR	\$0.84	BASE	\$2.43	BULL	\$26.17	ULTRA BULL	\$130.99
	-99.2% vs spot		-98.8% vs spot		-96.5% vs spot		-62.7% vs spot		+86.8% vs spot
TAM 0.7% P(fail) 60% S2C 0.6 Prob 10%		TAM 2.8% P(fail) 18% S2C 1.0 Prob 30%		TAM 7.6% P(fail) 12% S2C 1.3 Prob 42%		TAM 16.0% P(fail) 8% S2C 1.5 Prob 15%		TAM 32.0% P(fail) 4% S2C 1.7 Prob 3%	
Trapped-ion sidelined; equity wiped.		Quantinuum wins; IonQ #2 niche.		Co-leader w/ Quantinuum; ~17% mgn.		Trapped-ion wins; full-stack mgn.		Nvidia-of-quantum; SaaS multiple.	

PROBABILITY WEIGHTS

Ultra Bear 10% Bear 30% Base 42% Bull 15% Ultra Bull 3% · Weighted expected \$9.18 (-86.9% vs spot)

ULTRA BEAR	\$0.53	BEAR	\$0.84	BASE	\$2.43	BULL	\$26.17	ULTRA BULL	\$130.99
	-99.2% vs spot		-98.8% vs spot		-96.5% vs spot		-62.7% vs spot		+86.8% vs spot

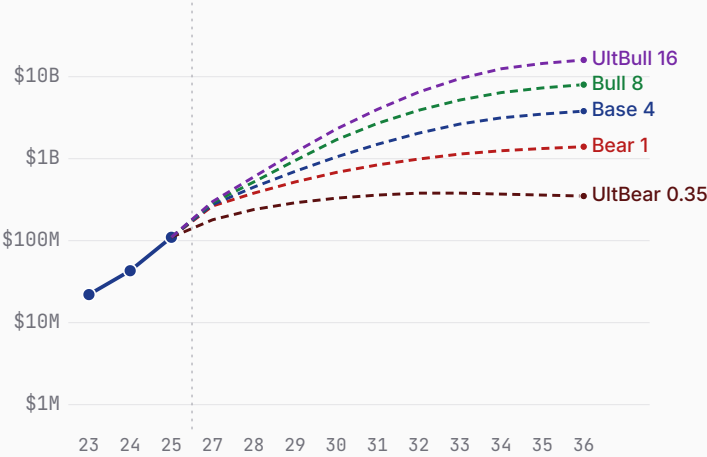
Probability 10%	Probability 30%	Probability 42%	Probability 15%	Probability 3%
Trapped-ion sidelined; equity wiped.	Quantinuum wins; IonQ #2 niche.	Co-leader w/ Quantinuum; ~17% mgn.	Trapped-ion wins; full-stack mgn.	Nvidia-of-quantum; SaaS multiple.
WHY 10% 10% reflects three compounding tail risks specific to trapped-ion: fundamental scaling ceiling around 100-500 qubits — credible physicists still debate this; Quantinuum's commercial dominance within the trapped-ion category after its \$12.7B IPO; the broader risk that "useful" quantum advantage stays elusive through 2030, starving the whole sector. Each individually 25-35%; conjunctive 8-12%. SkyWater acquisition adds \$1.8B of fab opex risk if quantum demand doesn't materialize.	WHY 30% Quantinuum's IPO at \$12.7B with materially better logical-qubit performance (48 logical at 99.92%) is a real competitive shift — Honeywell mfg + Cambridge Quantum SW is the most credible full-stack competitor. The broader quantum TAM consistently underperforms forecasts. IonQ executes technically but the pie is smaller and Quantinuum eats the premium slice. Within-scenario 18% p_fail reflects that even in the bear world, IonQ's cash position and DARPA contracts likely prevent bankruptcy. 30% weight reflects high-base-rate competitive entry has already happened.	WHY 42% Highest single bucket because the base requires no breakthrough — sequential execution on plans in motion (Tempo shipping, SkyWater vertical integration, AQ roadmap ahead of schedule, DARPA QBI participation, RPO converting). Coexistence with Quantinuum mirrors duopoly outcomes in adjacent deep-tech markets (AMD/Intel, ASML/Nikon). 42% sits below typical 50-55% base weights because quantum has more genuine tail risk than most categories — thin middle ground between "works commercially" and "doesn't." Five- scenario structure with fatter tails forces base weight down.	WHY 15% Chain of conditionals: AQ#256 ~on schedule (~70%), SkyWater 200K-qubit chip delivered 2028 (~60%), IonQ — not Quantinuum — captures the trapped-ion premium position (~50%), trapped-ion beats neutral-atom and superconducting on commercially relevant workloads at scale (~50%), DARPA/DOE flows weighted to IonQ (~60%). Each individually plausible; joint ~6-8% before correlation; correlated upward to ~12-18% because conditional outcomes reinforce. 15% is a real but non-modal tail.	WHY 3% Conjunctive bull chain × TAM upside × multiple expansion × competitor collapse. Each piece individually 40-60%; joint ~3-5%. Genuine tail capturing the world where quantum becomes a category- defining tech platform and IonQ is the dominant US pure-play. The asymmetrical-moonshots tier's reason-for-being: real upside that you can't get to without it.
WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT HAPPENS
Structural failure. Quantum advantage on commercial problems takes longer than the bull-deck slides project (BCG's revised "broad advantage 2030-2040" view); the NISQ era stays a science-fair through 2030. IonQ burns \$400-600M annually to AQ#256 with no commensurate revenue ramp. Worse, trapped-ion architecture hits a fundamental scaling wall around AQ#100: ion-shuttling complexity, vacuum-chamber engineering, and laser-stability budgets all degrade nonlinearly. Quantinuum's H-series, with the same physics and Honeywell's industrial-scale manufacturing, edges ahead and consolidates the trapped-ion niche.	Execution exists but the market shape disappoints. IonQ delivers AQ#256 by 2027 and the SkyWater 200K-qubit chip in 2028 — real milestones. But commercial demand stays government- and research-heavy: DARPA QBI, DOE, NQI, a handful of pharma POCs. Quantinuum's deeper logical-qubit lead wins enterprise mind-share post-IPO; IonQ becomes the credible #2 in trapped-ion, capturing premium government accounts but losing the big AWS/Azure/GCP enterprise-deployment race to superconducting.	Modal outcome. IonQ executes the published roadmap roughly on schedule: AQ#64 done, AQ#256 by 2027, SkyWater fab chips back in 2028, the 200K-qubit-chip class reached 2028-29. Quantinuum is a credible co-leader; the trapped-ion sub-segment becomes a duopoly (~50/50 share), with IonQ winning roughly half the US government, defense, and large-enterprise quantum-cloud business via existing AWS Braket / Azure Quantum / GCP integration. Neutral-atom takes cost-sensitive optimization; superconducting takes most "deep stack" enterprise via IBM/Google brand.	Trapped-ion is correct architecture and SkyWater compounds. By 2028 vertical integration via SkyWater proves out: the 200K-qubit chip arrives on schedule, error correction works, and IonQ demonstrates verifiable commercial quantum advantage on a customer workload (likely chemistry or optimization for a Fortune 50). Quantinuum stays credible #2 within trapped-ion but IonQ's vertical fab + cloud-native distribution wins the platform race. Neutral-atom struggles with fault tolerance; superconducting stalls between AQ-equivalent #500 and #2000 due to error-correction overhead.	Tail of tails. Every Bull condition hits AND the FY36 TAM is materially larger than consensus (Roots Analysis \$198B FY40 trajectory, McKinsey upper-bound \$72B by 2035 just for computing) AND IonQ achieves de facto platform monopoly in trapped-ion + becomes a meaningful chip foundry via SkyWater. Quantinuum struggles with IPO-era execution; superconducting hits fault- tolerance walls that trapped-ion's higher native fidelity sidesteps. IonQ becomes the "Nvidia of quantum" — vertically integrated, full-stack, with AWS/Azure/GCP installed customer base creating a software flywheel.
Meanwhile superconducting (IBM Nighthawk, Google Willow) achieves first verified commercial advantage at a price IonQ can't match per-shot. Neutral-atom scales past 2,000 atoms by FY28 and wins the cost curve. IonQ's \$470M RPO converts but never grows; FY30 revenue stalls below \$400M against \$500M+ cash burn including SkyWater fab opex. Cash exhausts mid-2029. Successive raises in 2028-2030 at \$40 → \$15 → \$4 dilute holders 4×. By FY32 the SkyWater fab is sold for parts; IonQ taken private at a token premium. With 60% within-scenario p_fail, distress recovery ~\$0.80. Expected per share ~\$0.50.	Revenue ramps to ~\$1.4B FY36 — strong absolute growth but tiny vs bull-deck \$5B+. SkyWater fab is a mixed asset: useful internally but underutilized as a third-party foundry, dragging margins. Operating margin matures around 8% — better than legacy services but well below cloud-software economics the current multiple implies. Cash burn averages \$300-400M through FY29; two raises (\$400M + \$1.0B) at \$50-30 prices add ~25M shares net. Final ~440M. With 18% within-scenario p_fail, DCF/share ~\$5; expected ~\$4.20.	By FY36 IonQ does ~\$3.8B revenue (~7.6% of \$50B TAM) at 17% mature operating margin — better than legacy hardware but below cloud-SaaS. SkyWater fab supplies internal demand plus third-party defense- electronics revenue. RPO converts steadily; multi-product customer share rises 35% → 60%+. Cash burn troughs at ~\$350M in FY28; a \$2.5B raise programme across years 1-7 at \$35-75 keeps cash≥0. SkyWater stock-portion dilution (~25M) folded in. Final shares ~450M. DCF/share ~\$16; with 12% within-scenario p_fail, expected ~\$14.70 — well below today's \$70 spot.	Revenue ramps to ~\$8B FY36 (~16% TAM share) with 27% mature operating margin — the SkyWater fab is now monetizing third-party customers as the dominant US trusted quantum-chip foundry. DARPA HARQ scales into a multi-billion national-security program. Federal NQI funding flows disproportionately to IonQ. Cash burn troughs FY28 then turns positive by FY30. A \$3.4B raise programme across years 1-7 at \$50-90 keeps cash≥0. Final shares ~450M. DCF/share ~\$54; with 8% within-scenario p_fail, expected ~\$50.	By FY36 IonQ does \$16B+ revenue at 33% mature operating margin (full-stack hardware + cloud + software-take-rate on partner apps). SkyWater fab serves the entire US national-security stack. Multiple expansion to software-hybrid premium. Modest \$3.1B raise in years 1-6 at \$70-100 maintains runway. Final shares ~435M. DCF/share ~\$135; with 4% p_fail, expected \$130.

IonQ business snapshot

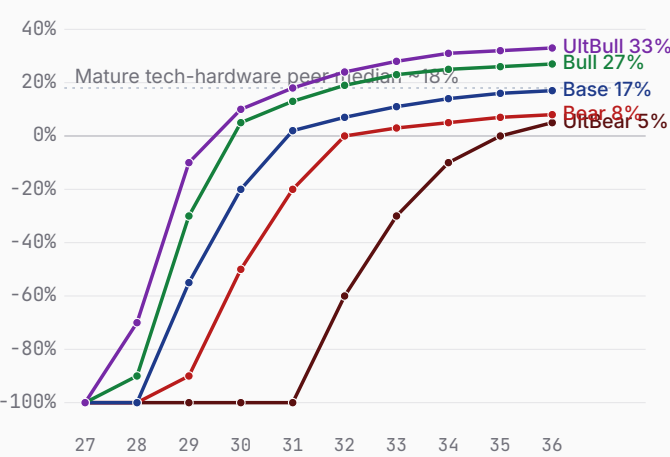
Bear \$0.84 Base \$2.43 Bull \$26.17

FY23-FY25 history + FY26 (guide) + FY27-FY36 scenario projections · fiscal years end Dec 31 · 10-K FY25, Q1 2026 10-Q, McKinsey Quantum Monitor 2026

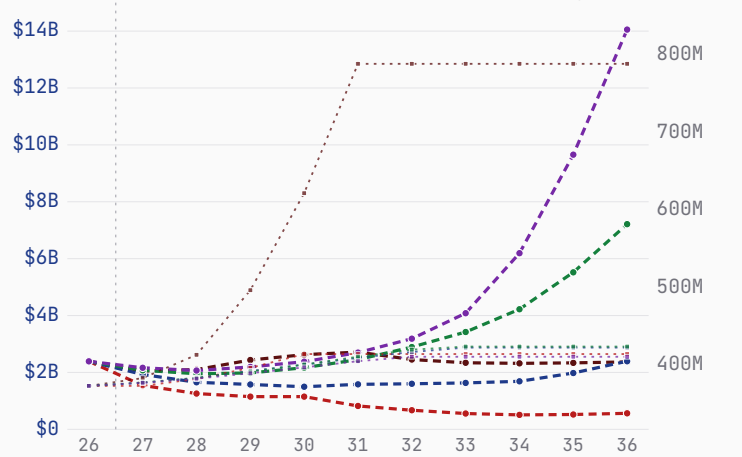
Revenue — history + scenarios to FY36 (log)



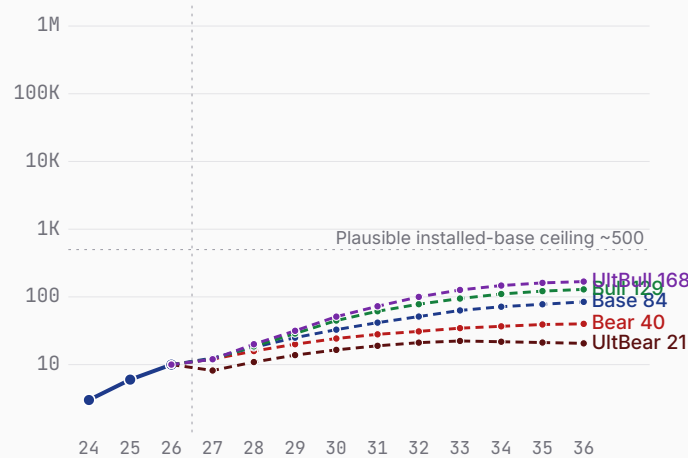
Path to profitability — op margin (FY27→FY36)



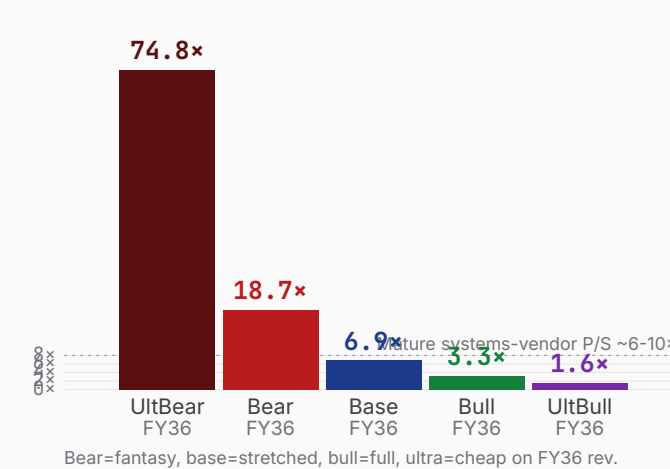
Cash + dilution (FY26 → FY36)



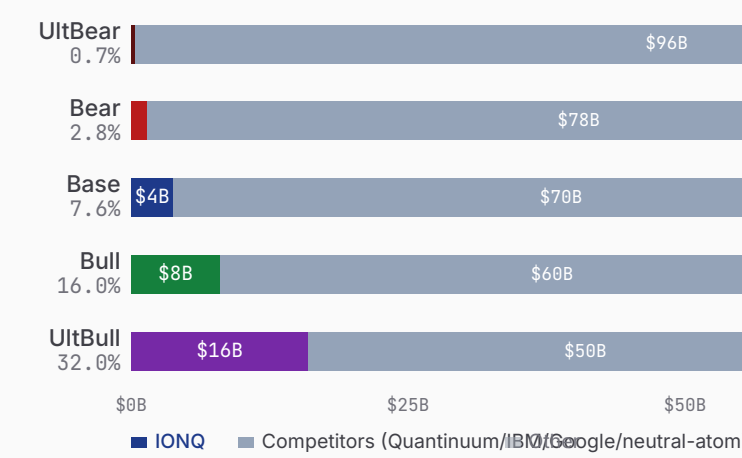
AQ#20+ class systems deployed (log)



\$26.17B mkt cap as P/S on FY36 rev



\$50B global quantum TAM (FY36) — IONQ share



Sources: IONQ Q1 2026 10-Q, FY25 10-K, IonQ Q1'26 earnings (8-K), Quantinuum S-1, McKinsey Quantum Technology Monitor 2026, BCG quantum value-creation revision, DARPA QBI Stage B selections (Nov 2025).

IonQ show your work

Bear \$0.84 Base \$2.43 Bull \$26.17 · Weighted \$9.18 (-86.9%)

ULTRA BEAR					\$0.53					BEAR					\$0.84					BASE					\$2.43					BULL					\$26.17					ULTRA BULL					\$130.99				
ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS				
TAM Year-10 (\$B)					50					TAM Year-10 (\$B)					50					TAM Year-10 (\$B)					50					TAM Year-10 (\$B)					50					TAM Year-10 (\$B)					50				
Mature share (%)					0.7					Mature share (%)					2.8					Mature share (%)					7.6					Mature share (%)					16.0					Mature share (%)					32.0				
Mature op margin (%)					5					Mature op margin (%)					8					Mature op margin (%)					17					Mature op margin (%)					27					Mature op margin (%)					33				
Sales-to-capital					0.6					Sales-to-capital					1.0					Sales-to-capital					1.3					Sales-to-capital					1.5					Sales-to-capital					1.7				
Terminal WACC (%)					10.0					Terminal WACC (%)					9.0					Terminal WACC (%)					8.5					Terminal WACC (%)					7.5					Terminal WACC (%)					7.0				
Terminal growth (%)					1.5					Terminal growth (%)					2.0					Terminal growth (%)					2.5					Terminal growth (%)					3.0					Terminal growth (%)					3.5				
P(failure) (%)					60					P(failure) (%)					18					P(failure) (%)					12					P(failure) (%)					8					P(failure) (%)					4				
Scenario probability (%)					10					Scenario probability (%)					30					Scenario probability (%)					42					Scenario probability (%)					15					Scenario probability (%)					3				
10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B				
FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF															
FY27	0.18	-300%	-0.64	-0.56	FY27	0.27	-220%	-0.70	-0.61	FY27	0.28	-200%	-0.69	-0.61	FY27	0.29	-180%	-0.68	-0.60	FY27	0.30	-150%	-0.63	-0.56	FY27	0.30	-150%	-0.63	-0.56	FY27	0.30	-150%	-0.63	-0.56															
FY28	0.24	-250%	-0.70	-0.54	FY28	0.38	-150%	-0.73	-0.57	FY28	0.45	-120%	-0.71	-0.56	FY28	0.52	-90%	-0.77	-0.61	FY28	0.60	-70%	-0.77	-0.63	FY28	0.60	-70%	-0.77	-0.63	FY28	0.60	-70%	-0.77	-0.63															
FY29	0.29	-200%	-0.66	-0.45	FY29	0.52	-90%	-0.63	-0.43	FY29	0.70	-55%	-0.64	-0.45	FY29	0.95	-30%	-0.79	-0.57	FY29	1.20	-10%	-0.83	-0.61	FY29	1.20	-10%	-0.83	-0.61	FY29	1.20	-10%	-0.83	-0.61															
FY30	0.33	-150%	-0.56	-0.34	FY30	0.68	-50%	-0.49	-0.30	FY30	1.05	-20%	-0.56	-0.35	FY30	1.70	+5%	-0.75	-0.49	FY30	2.30	+10%	-0.89	-0.60	FY30	2.30	+10%	-0.89	-0.60	FY30	2.30	+10%	-0.89	-0.60															
FY31	0.36	-100%	-0.41	-0.22	FY31	0.84	-20%	-0.32	-0.18	FY31	1.50	+2%	-0.42	-0.24	FY31	2.70	+13%	-0.72	-0.42	FY31	4.00	+18%	-0.75	-0.47	FY31	4.00	+18%	-0.75	-0.47	FY31	4.00	+18%	-0.75	-0.47															
FY32	0.38	-60%	-0.26	-0.12	FY32	0.99	+0%	-0.15	-0.07	FY32	2.05	+7%	-0.41	-0.21	FY32	3.90	+19%	-0.56	-0.30	FY32	6.50	+24%	-0.20	-0.12	FY32	6.50	+24%	-0.20	-0.12	FY32	6.50	+24%	-0.20	-0.12															
FY33	0.38	-30%	-0.11	-0.05	FY33	1.14	+3%	-0.08	-0.03	FY33	2.65	+11%	-0.31	-0.14	FY33	5.20	+23%	-0.10	-0.05	FY33	9.50	+28%	+0.90	+0.47	FY33	9.50	+28%	+0.90	+0.47	FY33	9.50	+28%	+0.90	+0.47															
FY34	0.37	-10%	-0.04	-0.01	FY34	1.25	+5%	-0.02	-0.01	FY34	3.15	+14%	-0.06	-0.03	FY34	6.40	+25%	+0.40	+0.18	FY34	12.50	+31%	+2.11	+1.04	FY34	12.50	+31%	+2.11	+1.04	FY34	12.50	+31%	+2.11	+1.04															
FY35	0.36	+0%	+0.00	+0.00	FY35	1.33	+7%	+0.01	+0.01	FY35	3.50	+16%	+0.21	+0.08	FY35	7.30	+26%	+1.00	+0.42	FY35	14.50	+32%	+3.46	+1.59	FY35	14.50	+32%	+3.46	+1.59	FY35	14.50	+32%	+3.46	+1.59															
FY36	0.35	+5%	+0.02	+0.01	FY36	1.40	+8%	+0.04	+0.01	FY36	3.80	+17%	+0.35	+0.13	FY36	8.00	+27%	+1.46	+0.58	FY36	16.00	+33%	+4.40	+1.89	FY36	16.00	+33%	+4.40	+1.89	FY36	16.00	+33%	+4.40	+1.89															
Σ PV explicit FCF					-2.28					Σ PV explicit FCF					-2.20					Σ PV explicit FCF					-2.38					Σ PV explicit FCF					-1.87					Σ PV explicit FCF					+2.01				
+ PV terminal (g 1.5%)					0.07					+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)					0.21					+ PV terminal (g 2.5%)					2.13					+ PV terminal (g 3.0%)					13.19					+ PV terminal (g 3.5%)					55.89				
EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE				
Operating EV					\$-2.21B					Operating EV					\$-1.99B					Operating EV					\$-0.25B					Operating EV					\$11.32B					Operating EV					\$57.90B				
+ Cash & investments					\$2.39B					+ Cash & investments					\$2.39B					+ Cash & investments					\$1.40B					+ Cash & investments					\$1.40B					+ Cash & investments					\$1.40B				
= Equity value					\$0.18B					= Equity value					\$0.40B					= Equity value					\$1.15B					= Equity value					\$12.72B					= Equity value					\$59.30B				
Raised over period					\$3.50B					Raised over period					\$1.40B					Raised over period					\$2.50B					Raised over period					\$3.40B					Raised over period					\$3.10B				
Dilution by FY36					+75%					Dilution by FY36					+18%					Dilution by FY36					+20%					Dilution by FY36					+21%					Dilution by FY36					+17%				
FY36 shares (M)					1,492					FY36 shares (M)					440					FY36 shares (M)					450					FY36 shares (M)					450					FY36 shares (M)					435				
DCF per share					\$0.12					DCF per share					\$0.91					DCF per share					\$2.56					DCF per share					\$28.27					DCF per share					\$136.32				
× (1-P_fail) [40%]					\$0.05					× (1-P_fail) [82%]					\$0.75					× (1-P_fail) [88%]					\$2.25					× (1-P_fail) [92%]					\$26.01					× (1-P_fail) [96%]					\$130.87				
+ P_fail × distress [60% × \$0.80]					\$0.48					+ P_fail × distress [18% × \$0.50]					\$0.09					+ P_fail × distress [12% × \$1.50]					\$0.18					+ P_fail × distress [8% × \$2.00]					\$0.16					+ P_fail × distress [4% × \$3.00]					\$0.12				
= Expected per share					\$0.53					= Expected per share					\$0.84					= Expected per share					\$2.43					= Expected per share					\$26.17					= Expected per share					\$130.99				
FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT				
+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y																
\$0.85	\$1.37	\$2.21	\$3.57		\$1.29	\$1.99	\$3.06	\$4.71		\$3.65	\$5.49	\$8.26	\$12.42		\$37.57	\$53.94	\$77.43	\$111.17		\$183.72	\$257.68	\$361.41	\$506.89		\$183.72	\$257.68	\$361.41	\$506.89		\$183.72	\$257.68	\$361.41	\$506.89																
0.01×	0.02×	0.03×	0.05×		0.02×	0.03×	0.04×	0.07×		0.05×	0.08×	0.12×	0.18×		0.54×	0.77×	1.10×	1.58×		2.62×	3.67×	5.15×	7.23×		2.62×	3.67×	5.15×	7.23×		2.62×	3.67×	5.15×	7.23×																

lonQ supporting analysis · disclaimers · glossary

Bear \$0.84 Base \$2.43 Bull \$26.17

PUSHBACK · WHY THE BASE CASE IS TOO HARSH

- 1

Best-capitalized pure-play.
\$2.4B cash + \$470M RPO + SkyWater vertical integration. Multi-year runway with optionality no other public quantum has.
- 2

AQ#64 hit early.
Tempo achieved AQ#64 three months ahead of schedule — first to do so. Real execution beats slideware.
- 3

Federal tailwind is real.
DARPA QBI Stage B + HARQ + DOE/NQI's \$2.7B/5yr authorization disproportionately benefits US-based trusted-supply players.
- 4

Trapped-ion fidelity moat.
Industry-leading 2Q gate fidelity (~99.9%+) is a physics advantage, not process — hard for superconducting/neutral-atom to close.
- 5

Cloud distribution unique.
Available on AWS Braket, Azure Quantum, Google Cloud. Only Quantinuum has comparable reach; IBM/Google don't partner cross-platform.

FALSIFICATION TRIGGERS

Bear validation AQ#256 slips past 2027 · RPO conversion stalls · SkyWater close delays past Q3 2026 · Quantinuum wins a marquee enterprise displacement	Bull validation AQ#256 hit by H1 2027 · First verified commercial quantum advantage on customer workload · Multi-product share >50% · 2nd large govt contract (>\$100M)	Reframe needed If neutral-atom (QuEra/Atom Computing) achieves fault-tolerance first — trapped-ion premium thesis erodes; revisit TAM share assumptions across all scenarios
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Forward-looking statements. Scenarios, valuations, projections, and any forward-looking statements involve substantial assumptions and uncertainty. Actual results may differ materially from those projected. Past performance is not indicative of future results. The model is a model; reality is not.	Author may hold positions. The author may own, intend to acquire, or hold short exposure to \$IONQ or related securities at any time. Positions may change without notice and without an update to this document. Do not assume the author's positions match the tone of the analysis.	Do your own research. Do not make investment decisions on the basis of this document. Consult a licensed financial professional and read the company's official SEC filings (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, proxy) before forming any investment view. If you wouldn't trust your retirement to a chatbot, don't trust this either.

GLOSSARY · CONCEPTS REFERENCED IN THE NARRATIVE

Trapped-ion qubits — lonQ's qubit modality — ytterbium ions in electromagnetic traps, manipulated by lasers. Highest gate fidelity but slower clock than superconducting.	AQ (Algorithmic Qubits) — lonQ's benchmark for usable capacity. AQ#N = circuits requiring 2^N states. AQ#64 hit 2026; AQ#256 targeted 2027.	Quantum advantage — Quantum solving a problem faster/cheaper than classical. Google's Willow demonstrated verifiable advantage on chemistry Oct 2025; no commercial advantage verified yet.
Quantinuum — Honeywell-backed full-stack trapped-ion competitor. Filed for \$12.7B IPO May 2026; better logical-qubit performance (48 logical at 99.92%).	SkyWater — US semiconductor foundry lonQ is acquiring (~\$1.8B, closes Q2/Q3 2026). Domestic chip fab — enables 200K-qubit chip in 2028.	Tempo / Forte — lonQ system generations. Forte = current commercial (AQ#36). Tempo = next-gen, AQ#64 demonstrated, 256-qubit chip.